

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION

ORDER NO. 83-088

WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS
FOR
RICHGROVE COMMUNITY SERVICES DISTRICT
WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
TULARE COUNTY

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region (hereafter Board), finds that:

1. Richgrove Community Services District (hereafter Discharger) encompasses an unincorporated community. The area is unsewered and in the south part of Tulare County and eight miles east of Delano.
2. Waste disposal within the community is currently accomplished by individual systems, including septic tank-leachfields, cesspools, gray water systems, and outdoor privies. The total wastewater flow for the community has been estimated as 120,000 gpd (5.3 l/sec) with peak summer flows exceeding 200,000 gpd (8.7 l/sec).
3. Local soil conditions are variable. Southwest Richgrove has acceptable conditions for leaching systems; however, the northeast area has restricting hardpan.
4. Ground water is found at depths of 270 feet (82 m) to 300 feet (93 m) below ground surface. Ground water is generally of good to excellent quality with electrical conductivity ranging from 350 to 400 umhos.
5. The beneficial uses of the ground water are:
 - a. Domestic supply
 - b. Industrial supply
 - c. Irrigation
6. A Tulare County Health Department survey conducted during August, 1978 found surfacing effluent or backed up sewage in 55 percent of the systems. Bacteria was also found in the community water supply well.
7. Inspections by Regional Board staff and representatives from state and local agencies have corroborated County Health Department findings.
8. To correct the sewage disposal problems in the community, the Discharger is currently involved in a Clean Water Grant project to construct a collection system, interceptor, and treatment/disposal facilities.

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9. Treatment will be accomplished by an aerated lagoon and stabilization ponds designed for an average dry weather flow of 0.22 mgd (9.6 l/sec). Disposal of the treated effluent is proposed to be accomplished by flood irrigation of fodder, fiber, and seed-type crops.
10. The Board, on 24 October 1980, adopted Order No. 80-158 which prescribed requirements for the Discharger. The Order does not reflect the proposed treatment and disposal methods, and therefore, is no longer adequate.
11. The Board, on 25 July 1975, adopted a Water Quality Control Plan for the Tulare Lake Basin (5D) which contains water quality objectives. These requirements are consistent with that Plan.
12. The Discharger has adopted a final environmental impact report in accordance with the California Environmental Quality Act (Public Resources Code Section 21000, et seq.), and the State Guidelines.
13. The Board has reviewed the EIR and concurs there are no significant impacts on water quality.
14. The Board has notified the Discharger and interested agencies and persons of its intent to prescribe waste discharge requirements for this discharge.
15. The Board, in a public hearing, heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.

IT IS HEREBY ORDERED, that Order No. 80-158 be rescinded, and Richgrove Community Services District, in order to meet the provisions contained in Division 7 of the California Water Code and regulations adopted thereunder, shall comply with the following:

A. Discharge Prohibitions:

1. The direct discharge of wastes to surface waters or surface water drainage courses is prohibited.
2. The by-pass or overflow of untreated or partially treated waste is prohibited.

B. Discharge Specifications:

1. Neither the treatment nor the discharge shall cause a pollution or nuisance as defined by the California Water Code, Section 13050.

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2. The discharge shall not cause degradation of any water supply.
3. The discharge shall, at all times, remain within the designated disposal area owned or controlled by the Discharger.
4. The average daily dry weather discharge shall not exceed 0.22 mgd (9.6 l/sec).
5. The 30-day average settleable solids concentration of effluent used for reclamation purposes shall not exceed 0.5 ml/l. Reclamation shall be limited to surface irrigation of fodder, fiber, and seed crops.
6. The dissolved oxygen content in any treatment or holding pond shall not be less than 1.0 mg/l for 16 hours in any 24-hour period.
7. Public access shall be precluded from the treatment and disposal area by a satisfactory combination of fencing, signing, and irrigation management practices.
8. The maximum electrical conductivity (EC) of the discharge shall not exceed the average EC of the source water plus 500 micromhos.
9. Collected screening, sludges, and other solids removed from liquid wastes shall be disposed of in a manner approved by the Executive Officer.

C. Provisions:

1. The Discharger shall be in full compliance with these requirements upon adoption, except for Discharge Specification Nos. 4 through 9, which shall become effective upon completion of the following time schedule:

<u>Task</u>	<u>Date</u>	<u>Report of Compliance Date</u>
Begin Construction of Wastewater Treatment and Disposal Facilities	1 August 1983	15 August 1983
Submit Construction Progress Report	----	15 January 1984

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<u>Task</u>	<u>Date</u>	<u>Report of Compliance Date</u>
Complete Construction	1 August 1984	15 August 1984
Achieve Full Compliance With This Order	1 September 1984	15 September 1984
2. The Discharger shall comply with the attached Monitoring and Reporting Program No. <u>83-088</u> .		
3. The Discharger shall comply with the Standard Provisions and Reporting Requirements, dated 21 September 1979, which are a part of this Order.		
4. By 1 June 1984, the Discharger shall provide certified wastewater treatment plant operators in accordance with regulations adopted by the State Water Resources Control Board.		
5. The Discharger shall report promptly to the Board any material change or proposed change in the character, location, or volume of the discharge.		
6. In the event of any change in control or ownership of land or waste discharge facilities presently owned or controlled by the Discharger, the Discharger shall notify the succeeding owner or operator of the existence of this Order by letter, a copy of which shall be forwarded to this office.		
7. The Board will review this Order periodically and may revise require- ments when necessary.		

I, WILLIAM H. CROOKS, Executive Officer, do hereby certify the foregoing is
a full, true, and correct copy of an Order adopted by the California Regional
Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, on 12 August 1983.



WILLIAM H. CROOKS, Executive Officer

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05/06/83

Attachments

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. 83-088

FOR
RICHGROVE COMMUNITY SERVICES DISTRICT
WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
TULARE COUNTY

EFFLUENT MONITORING

The Discharger shall implement the following effluent monitoring program upon completion of the construction time schedule:

Representative samples shall be collected at the treatment facility according to the specified frequency:

<u>Measurement</u>	<u>Unit</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
Average Daily Flow	mgd (l/sec)	Continuous	Daily
Dissolved Oxygen ^{1/}	mg/l	Grab	2/week
Settleable Solids	ml/l	Grab	2/week
Specific Electrical Conductance @25°C	umhos/cm	Grab	Monthly

1/ Sample to be collected from a location opposite each pond inlet between the hours of 0800 and 0900.

DISPOSAL SITE MONITORING

The following disposal site monitoring program shall be implemented by the Discharger:

1. The area of land utilized for disposal of wastes shall be estimated and reported monthly.
2. A minimum of six representative locations shall be established for soil profile sampling. The following shall constitute the site monitoring program:

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM
RICHGROVE COMMUNITY SERVICES DISTRICT
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<u>Measurement</u>	<u>Unit</u>	<u>Depth of Soil Profile</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
Nitrate Nitrogen	mg/kg	6 feet (1.8 m) ^{1/}	Annually ^{2/}
Total Nitrogen	mg/kg	6 feet (1.8 m) ^{1/}	Annually ^{2/}

1/ Samples shall be collected at 2 foot (0.6 m) increments.

2/ Each location shall be sampled (a) initially for background levels at least 30 days prior to any discharge, and then, (b) annually thereafter during the month of August.

REPORTING

The Effluent Monitoring Reports shall be submitted to the Regional Board office on a monthly basis by the 15th day of the following month.

The Disposal Site Monitoring Reports shall be submitted annually by 1 January of each year.

In reporting the monitoring data, the Discharger shall arrange the data in tabular form so that the date, the constituents, and the concentrations are readily discernible. The data shall be summarized in such a manner to illustrate clearly the compliance with waste discharge requirements.

The Discharger shall submit with the initial report, a diagram indicating the location of the sampling stations in relation to the treatment facility or disposal site.

Ordered by W. H. Crooks
WILLIAM H. CROOKS, Executive Officer

12 August 1983
(Date)

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05/06/83

INFORMATION SHEET

RICHGROVE COMMUNITY SERVICES DISTRICT WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY TULARE COUNTY

Richgrove is an unsewered, rural community in southern Tulare County, in Section 36, T24S, R26E, MDB&M, and the contiguous Section 31. Richgrove is eight miles east of Delano and three miles west of Highway 65. Southern Pacific Railroad's Porterville line goes past the community. Its southerly boundary is the Kern County line and the north bank of Rag Gulch.

A Tulare County Health Department survey conducted in August 1978 concluded that there are definite disposal problems in Richgrove that have resulted in ground water pollution and threatened health hazards. The problems identified include plugged plumbing, backed up systems, and surfacing sewage. Contributing factors to the problem are small lots, tight soil conditions, minimal construction standards and poor or no maintenance of systems.

To correct the sewage disposal problems, Richgrove Community Services District has been involved in a Clean Water Grant Project to construct a collection system, interceptor, treatment plant, and disposal area.

The treatment facility will include an aerated lagoon and stabilization ponds designed for an average dry weather flow of 0.22 mgd (9.6 l/sec). The District proposes to flood irrigate fodder, fiber and seed-type crops with the treated effluent. The disposal site will be owned and controlled by the District.

Ground water in the area is found at depths of 270 feet (82 m) to 300 feet (93 m) below ground surface. Ground water is generally of good to excellent quality with electrical conductivity ranging from 350 to 400 umhos.

The beneficial uses of ground water include:

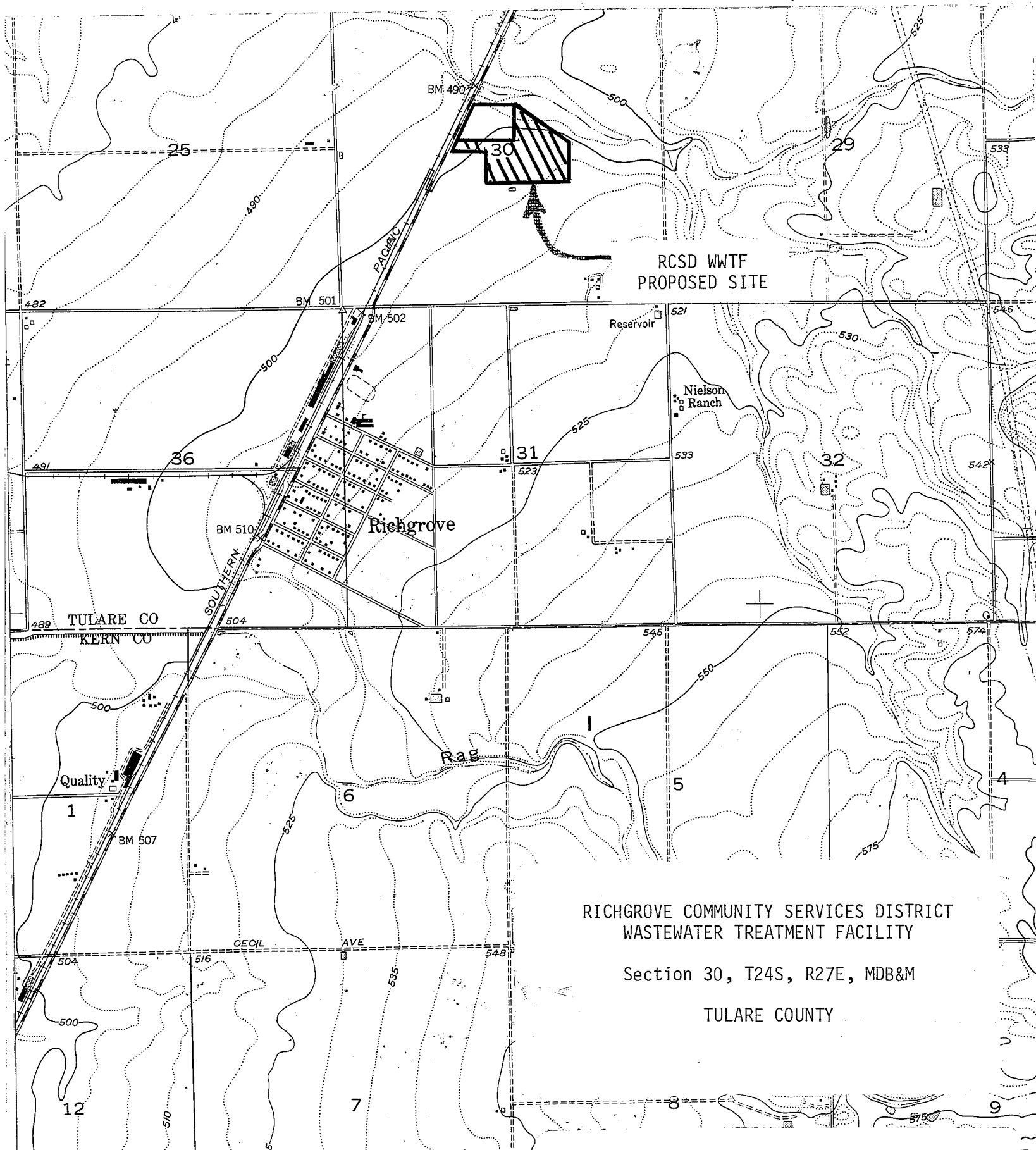
- a. Domestic supply
- b. Industrial supply
- c. Irrigation

Local soil conditions vary through the community from moderately well drained Greenfield sandy loams in the southwest portion of the community to hardpan restricted Exeter sandy loams in the northeast. These soil conditions are generally rated as moderate to severe for on-site leaching systems.

The District has prepared a Final Environmental Impact Report for the proposed project in accordance with the requirements of the California Environmental Quality Act. The Board staff has reviewed the EIR and concurs with the findings that there will not be any significant adverse impacts on water quality resulting from the project.

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RCSD WWTF
PROPOSED SITE

Richgrove

Nielson
Ranch

Reservoir

Quality

Rag

OECIL
AVE

RICHGROVE COMMUNITY SERVICES DISTRICT
WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY

Section 30, T24S, R27E, MDB&M

TULARE COUNTY